

NASHVILLE BRIDE — Story Document / Paper Edit

— v2

Episode: "The Yes Dress" (Sarah & Garrison)

What's different in v2 (vs v1): dress talk and the meat-and-potatoes story lead; small talk is demoted to one-line lead-ins. Dress beats now carry the actual on-camera lines so the editor has the meat in hand. Runtime re-budgeted toward the stakes (Act 3), the reveal (Act 4), and the speech (Act 5). Remaining filler is tagged **[[TRIM]]**. Sections 1–3 and the cold open are unchanged from v1.

1. LOGLINE

A Nashville barista and single mom keeps postponing the wedding she and the man who became a father to her kids simply can't afford — until Dom and his three single coworkers surprise her with her dream gown, and in handing Sarah her forever, each of them edges closer to believing in their own.

2. STORY BREAKDOWN

A-STORY — Dom's gift (the spine). Dom set out to remove the one thing standing between Sarah and her wedding: the dress. He hand-picks three gowns, previews them on a model so the team can strategize, then surprises Sarah with a VIP fitting that ends in a "yes dress" and a party. The engine is *anticipation* → *reveal* → *celebration*; Dom's private stakes (a man who still believes in marriage after his own divorce) give the gift its weight.

B-STORY — The team's own hearts. All three women are single, pouring themselves into someone else's love story while quietly working on their own. Seeded at the rooftop (2f) and echoed in Danielle's self-love journey, it pays off at the party: helping Sarah say yes makes each of them want — and believe they deserve — their own person.

C-STORY — Sarah & Garrison (the stakes). They met at Sarah's brother's wedding. She's a single mom working a coffee counter; he's the steady guy who became a role model to her kids and writes her songs. They've set a date, changed it, postponed it — financial stress, life stress — always putting the wedding last. The dress is the first domino. Take it down and "it's happening now."

3. CHARACTER ARCS (start → want → obstacle → end)

- **Dom** — confident ringleader → wants to prove marriage is still worth believing in → his own divorce/lean years make it personal → undone by Sarah's tears, "balled like a baby," names the team his family.
- **Sarah** — guarded, "I don't know anything" → wants to feel like a bride, not a to-do list → a chaotic, money-tight life → "I feel like a wife." The dress beats her childhood picture.

- **Garrison** — the offscreen "why aren't you married yet?" → wants to finally give her the wedding → finances/timing/pride → set up to "ball his eyes out" at the aisle.
- **Danielle** — warm real-estate pro / dog mom → genuine connection after a rough history → patterns she's unlearning (visa marriage, a petty ex) → "I'm proud of myself," lands on gratitude.
- **Savannah** — the newcomer, freshly single → belonging and her own love story → still bruised → reframes what she's looking for: "someone that truly sees me in the little moments."
- **Muff** — skeptic-with-taste, "corset girly," here for work → not to get swept up → gets swept up → "I'm digging Sarah for sure."

4. ACT-BY-ACT BEAT SHEET (v2 — dress & story forward)

Priority order in every act: dress talk → C-story stakes → A-story mechanics → B-story. Side talk = one-line lead-in only, and only for the three threads that pay off (**line dancing**, **Nashville**, **personal**). Cheesy filler is tagged **[[TRIM]]**. Dress beats include the **on-camera lines** to cut from.

COLD OPEN — (~1:30) *emotion only, NO dress* — unchanged from v1

Beat	Action	Footage ref	Function
CO-1	Dom: "a lot of brides can't afford to get married... the dress is the first piece to the puzzle."	S1 01:01:10	State the why
CO-2	Stakes: Garrison "writes songs for you?... for our kids." A couple who put the wedding last.	S4 01:59:38	Plant love + cost
CO-3	Tease emotion (reaction only, NO gown): Sarah welling, "I've been trying not to cry"; Dom watching.	S4 02:03:47 / 02:05:29	Gut-hook
CO-4	Button: "This is bigger than the whole thing."	INT 04:22:30	Promise of payoff

TITLES.

ACT 1 — THE BRIEF — (~5:00) (*was 6:30 — tightened*)

Beat	Action / lines	Footage ref	Function
1-1	Quick cold-energy open — pickleball, 10–15s of motion only. [[TRIM]] the extended pickleball banter.	S1 01:00:05–01:00:17	Tone, fast
1-2	The brief (story): the bride is Sarah , fiancé Garrison , a beach wedding ; Dom's already picked her dresses.	S1 01:00:17–01:00:31	Mission target
1-3	Mission heart: "a lot of brides just can't afford to get married... the dress is the first piece to the puzzle." / "something I've always wanted to do is give back."	S1 01:01:10–01:01:22	The why
1-4	(<i>one-line lead-in, personal thread</i>) the team's all single — a single beat.	S2 01:08:05	Plant B-story
ACT-OUT	"Y'all sold?" "Sold." → rooftop, "convince us."	S1 01:00:53	Hook: what did Dom pick?

ACT 2 — ROOFTOP PREVIEW — (~7:30) (was 8:00 — dress-forward)

Order: Dom + Alex → champagne (brief) → Dress 1 → Dress 2 → Dress 3 → one side-talk beat → Savannah.

Beat	Action / dress lines	Footage ref	Function
2-1	Dom introduces model Alex — "this is Alex... we got Sarah, she's our bride."	01:09:30	Start preview
2-2	Champagne — brief toast/sip (~20s), "let's do it."	2a 01:09:53–01:11:03	Glam beat
2-3	DRESS 1 — beach / room-to-dance. Lines: "love it" · "that's so cool, wow" · "it popped out and floated, so it stayed on top" · "I'd go for ease on the beach... the light hits the pearl" · Dom: "champagne color... the sand, her white flowers, her arch."	2b 01:14:05–01:16:16; 01:17:39; 01:24:45	Beach + dance brief
2-4	DRESS 2 — graphic / ballroom "contender." Lines: "I'm loving this one more... it's very graphic" · "the shape is perfect... the way it sits, it's very beautiful" · "I wanted a little more ballroom... the ballroom venue" · "it's a contender." Dom: "I wanted to give her options... all the dresses have the same shape."	2c 01:16:40–01:18:33	Options = stakes
2-5	DRESS 3 — corset / sleeves (the favorite). Lines: "that top speaks to me — I love a corset" · "the girls are popping out" · "I love the sleeves" · "I love the waistline" · "does it feel heavy?" → Dom: beads = weight · scoring "an eight" / "8.5" / "it's a 10 for me, I want it." Dom philosophy: "those baby tears the first time... you know she found her dress."	2d 01:22:00–01:24:21; 01:22:18	Pre-sell the reveal
2-6	Side talk — ONE beat: Dom's pick (torn 1 vs 2, champagne for the beach, "strong variety") + a single thread line (line dancing or Nashville). [[TRIM]] the Lowe's-clips bit, wine/cigars, extended getting-to-know.	2e 01:24:45–01:25:33	Strategy, brief
2-7	Savannah's emotional story (B-story plant) — the one real valley. (<i>confirm narrator — Notes</i>)	2f ~01:36:00–01:38:16	Plant the payoff
ACT-OUT	"Thank you, Alex." → now we meet her.	01:25:55	Hook: who is Sarah?

ACT 3 — MEETING SARAH / THE STAKES — (~9:00) (was 8:00 — C-story expanded)

Beat	Action / story lines	Footage ref	Function
3-1	Surprise at home — brief. "What are you guys doing here?"	3/S3 01:38:16	Meet the couple
3-2	How they met: "at my brother's wedding — we were both in the wedding."	3a 01:41:38	Love-story origin
3-3	The postponement: "we had a date set, we changed it, then we postponed it... ideally June 5th, 2027."	3a 01:46:43	The wound
3-4	THE CORE (let it breathe): "Why postponed? Financial reasons... life stresses... I want to feel like a bride and have that bridal glow and not stress about other things."	3a 01:47:19–01:47:48	Emotional core
3-5	Garrison the good man: writes her songs / role model to her kids (seed for the speech). "You're such a sweet man... I picked a good one."	01:47:48; 01:59:38	Make us root

Beat	Action / story lines	Footage ref	Function
3-6	Dom turns it: "We're going to find you a dress today... girls day."	01:47:58– 01:48:34	Launch the fitting
ACT-OUT	Coffee-shop nod, into the car.	01:48:19	Hook: will she find THE dress?

ACT 4 — THE YES DRESS — (~11:00) ★ PEAK (was 10:00 — reveal + dress expanded)

Beat	Action / dress lines	Footage ref	Function
4-1	Walk-up — VIP welcome, dogs, Yousuf. Brief.	4a 01:49:13	Glam reset
4-2	DRESS 1 — beaded ballgown. Lines: <i>"I feel like a princess"</i> · <i>"I like the beadwork surprisingly"</i> · <i>"the beads start to rub up my arm"</i> · <i>"we want the wedding 90% party... worried about dancing in this"</i> · <i>"it's more ball gown than I'd go for — not my dancing dress."</i>	4b 01:53:21– 01:55:25	Establish taste; raise bar
4-3	(one-line lead-in, personal thread) "all single, bridal superheroes." [[TRIM]] the rest of the banter.	4b 01:52:24	Tie B-story, brief
4-4	DRESS 2 — the glow / graphic. Lines: <i>"you have more of a glow in your face"</i> · <i>"you walked out like boom"</i> · <i>"the neckline is so flattering"</i> · <i>"I love the boning and the corset"</i> · <i>"it's a good dancing dress — I can dance all out"</i> · Muff: <i>"I told you guys, graphic."</i>	4c 01:57:51– 02:00:41	False peak — "she might cry twice"
4-5	Options/stakes: "we can always add sleeves" / "there's a wedding dress and a party dress" → "the only thing standing in their way... now it's happening."	4c 02:01:04– 02:02:13	Hold tension; restate stakes
4-6	★ DRESS 3 — THE YES DRESS. Lines: <i>"I'm gonna cry right now"</i> · <i>"that corset — I love the deep V"</i> · <i>"the lace on your hands... stunning for photo"</i> · <i>"I'm ready to walk down the aisle"</i> · veil: <i>"I actually have chills"</i> · <i>"I feel like a wife"</i> · "Is this your yes dress?" "Yes." · <i>"it's better than what I envisioned."</i>	4d 02:02:40– 02:10:40	THE PEAK
4-7	Forward-promise: "Garrison's not gonna know what hit him... he's gonna bawl his eyes out."	4d 02:05:48	Promise the aisle
4-8	Sarah-PRIORITY interviews (rawest), then team.	4e 02:13:45– 02:15:48	Land the feeling
ACT-OUT	"Is this the yes dress? Yes — we have to celebrate!"	02:10:40	Hook: the party / why did Dom do this?

ACT 5 — PARTY / THE SPEECH — (~11:00) (protect the speech)

Beat	Action / story lines	Footage ref	Function
5-1	Arrival — couple out of element; girls greet Sarah FIRST ("my tribe"). Brief.	5a 03:09:01; INT 04:33:20	Reunion warmth
5-2	Line dancing (fun peak + payoff thread) — Justin Lee teaches; flailing in heels.	5b 03:49:14– 03:59:40	High-energy

Beat	Action / story lines	Footage ref	Function
5-3	Side talk — ONE valley beat (personal/Nashville/dance recap). [[TRIM]] the long party tangents.	5c party b-roll	Breath
5-4	Party interviews — B-story payoff: "so much bigger than marriage" / "someone who sees me in the little moments" / Muff "digging Sarah for sure."	5d 04:24:10–04:41:58	Pay off the hearts
5-5	★ THE SPEECH (the reveal — give it room): met Garrison at the cigar bar , Sarah's the barista who knows his order , the truck-battery day → "tell me your story," " why aren't y'all married? — it's been tough, financially." "This was real for me... I balled like a baby."	5e 04:11:18–04:23:06 (core 04:19:27–04:22:32)	Meaning over fun
5-6	"These people are my family." Cheers to Sarah & Garrison.	5e 04:13:36	Family button
TAG	A single woman's quiet hope → forward to the wedding (June 5, 2027) & the next bride.	INT 04:40:30	"Only the beginning"

5. COLD OPEN (60–90s) — unchanged from v1

- "There's a lot of brides out there that just can't afford to get married... the dress is the first piece to the puzzle." (01:01:10)
- Cut to stakes — Garrison writes her songs (01:59:38); a couple who keep putting the wedding last.
- Reaction-only escalation: Sarah welling, "I've been trying not to cry" (02:03:47); Dom watching. **Camera off the dress.**
- Button: "When Sarah started crying... it brought my whole vision together" (02:15:11) → "This is bigger than the whole thing." (04:22:30) → TITLES before any wide of the gown.

6. RUNTIME BUDGET — v2 (target ~45:00)

Segment	v1	v2	Change
Cold Open	1:30	1:30	—
Act 1 — The Brief	6:30	5:00	–1:30 (cut pickleball small talk)
Act 2 — Rooftop Preview	8:00	7:30	–0:30 (less side talk, more dress)
Act 3 — Meeting Sarah / Stakes	8:00	9:00	+1:00 (C-story breathes)
Act 4 — The Yes Dress	10:00	11:00	+1:00 (reveal + dress)
Act 5 — Party / Speech	11:00	11:00	— (trim party side talk → protect speech)
Total	45:00	45:00	—

Net effect: time moves **out of small talk (Acts 1–2)** and **into the stakes, the reveal, and the speech**. Peak (yes dress) still lands $\approx \frac{2}{3}$ in.

7. NOTES (v2)

Trim candidates (drop first if tight):

- Extended **pickleball banter** (Act 1) — keep 10–15s of energy only.
- The "**Lowe's clips**" **bit**, wine/beer/cigars, and the long rooftop getting-to-know (Act 2) — one thread line max.
- The **store fitting banter** between gowns (Act 4) — one B-story line, then back to the dress.
- The **long party tangents** (Act 5) — one valley beat; protect the line-dance payoff and the speech.

Keep tight on the threads that pay off: line dancing (rooftop want → party lesson), Nashville (setting), personal (single life → B-story). Everything else is filler.

Pickups (carried from v1):

- **Sarah's solo confessional** right after the reveal (PRIORITY) — the transcript has only in-scene reactions.
- **Garrison reaction** pickup / aisle-day tag — closes his arc.
- **Champagne toast** is B-roll — recover a clean "cheers to Sarah" on relisten (01:09:53–01:11:03).
- **Speaker-ID verification** for 2f narrator (Savannah vs Danielle) — decides the B-story attribution. See [Nashville_Bride_SpeakerID_Worksheet](#).

Lines to build cold opens / act-outs from: "the dress is the first piece to the puzzle" · "this is bigger than the whole thing" · "Y'all sold? Sold." · "you know she found her dress." · "Get your bags packed — girls day." · "Is this the yes dress? Yes." · "this is only the beginning."